National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Belen, NM	**Accident Number:**	DEN08CA034
Date & Time:	11/27/2007, 1100 MST	**Registration:**	N74SR
Aircraft:	Godwin, David P Sorrell SNJ-7	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

According to the pilot's statement, he was landing on runway 21 and the winds were light and variable. Shortly after touchdown on the runway, he lost directional control and the airplane ground looped. The airplane departed the left side of the runway and came to rest upright. Examination of the airplane revealed that one main landing gear was separated and one was folded under the fuselage. Several right wing ribs were broken. No anomalies with the aircraft systems were reported.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: the pilot's loss of directional control during landing resulting in a ground loop.

Findings

Occurrence #1: LOSS OF CONTROL - ON GROUND/WATER
Phase of Operation: LANDING - ROLL

Findings
1. (C) DIRECTIONAL CONTROL - NOT MAINTAINED - PILOT IN COMMAND
2. (C) GROUND LOOP/SWERVE - INADVERTENT - PILOT IN COMMAND

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Private; Recreational	**Age:**	48, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	Balloon	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 3	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	05/01/2006
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	1364 hours (Total, all aircraft), 14 hours (Total, this make and model), 26 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 5 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Godwin, David P	**Registration:**	N74SR
Model/Series:	Sorrell SNJ-7	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	Yes
Airworthiness Certificate:	Experimental	**Serial Number:**	280
Landing Gear Type:	Tailwheel	**Seats:**	
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	05/01/2007, Condition	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:		**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:		**Engine Model/Series:**	O-360-A1A-5
Registered Owner:	ABQ New Mexico Adventure Tours	**Rated Power:**	180 hp
Operator:	David w. Shuckhart	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:		**Distance from Accident Site:**	
Observation Time:		**Direction from Accident Site:**	
Lowest Cloud Condition:		**Visibility**	
Lowest Ceiling:		**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	/	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:		**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:		**Temperature/Dew Point:**	
Precipitation and Obscuration:			
Departure Point:	Belen, NM (E80)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:		**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	MST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	Alexander Municipal Airport (E80)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	5194 ft	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	21	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	6601 ft / 60 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Full Stop; Traffic Pattern

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	34.645000, -106.833611

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Aaron M Sauer	**Report Date:**	01/31/2008
Additional Participating Persons:			
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

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The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.